

Frequently Asked Questions on NSF MathCounts Coaching

MATHCOUNTS Competition:

1. What is MATHCOUNTS?

MATHCOUNTS is a National Math Competition open for students in 6th, 7th and 8th grades. MATHCOUNTS reaches over 250,000 US middle school students with more than 125,000 competing in the MATHCOUNTS competition series. In the most recent MATHCOUNTS alumni survey from the respondents who competed in MATHCOUNTS at state level, the average SAT score for the three sections was 2194, which shows students who compete at this level not only excel at mathematics.

There are 4 rounds of MATHCOUNTS: School, Chapter, State and National. First the student participates in the School round and if gets selected advances to Chapter. From Chapter round, the top scoring team and the individuals advance to State round and from State, 4 top individuals will compete in Nationals representing their state. Generally, the School Competition takes place in January, Chapter in February, State in March, and the National Competition in May. More information about MATHCOUNTS competitions can be obtained from www.mathcounts.org

2. How can my child participate in MATHCOUNTS competition?

To participate in MATHCOUNTS, your child needs to start from the school. Check with your school if there is a coach who conducts the school level competition. From there he needs to advance to Chapter, State and Nationals.

3. My child's school does not participate in MATHCOUNTS, what can be done about it?

You can talk to your school and conduct the MATHCOUNTS School Competition and take the top scoring students to the Chapter Competition. Sometimes, it may not be easy to convince the school management. Many schools don't like to participate in just one specific competition as only very few kids can participate. Schools want to give opportunity to a large set of students. One way to approach this is to start a math club which meets once a week. This will allow any kid to participate in a weekly math learning activity. The club in addition to helping learn can expose the kids to many competitions including MATHCOUNTS, AMC 8, Math League etc.

4. My child is home schooled, can he participate in MATHCOUNTS?

Yes, your child can still participate in MATHCOUNTS. An affidavit is available in the website www.mathcounts.org for the homeschool children. Prior to the Chapter Competition, it has to be filled and given to the chapter coordinator and if your child advances to the State Competition, it is forwarded to the state coordinator by the chapter coordinator. If he/she advances to national Competition, the affidavit is forwarded to the national office by the state coordinator.